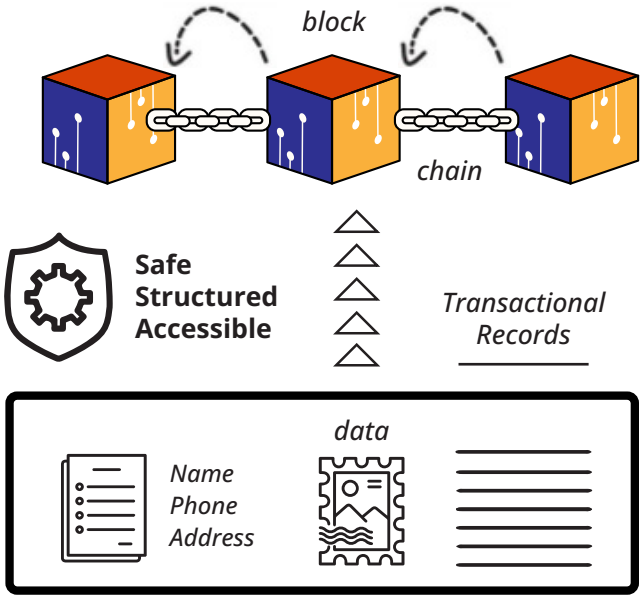
A **blockchain** is like a history book. Each page (or "**block**") has a list of things that happened (**transactions**). As more things happen, we need to add new pages (blocks) to the book. Anyone can read the book for free, but only special helpers (**miners**) can add new pages. They make sure that what's written is true. Once something is written in the book, it can't be changed or erased. It's a permanent record of all the **transactions** that have happened on the **blockchain**.

- A **blockchain** does not have a central authority (like an author, a publisher or an editor) that can edit, delete or change the information recorded in it, hence it's considered a more secure and reliable method of record keeping compared to a traditional central database.

What is a blockchain?

All records of actions on the blockchain are called transactions.



If the helpers (**miners**) are not in **consensus** about the validity of the pages (**blocks**), they will be rejected and will not be added to the **blockchain**.

But in order to understand the **blockchain**, we have to get a sense of the context in which it exists. While many feel that the **blockchain** has uses as an independent innovation, its true founding role is singular: to create an immutable ledger so that a decentralized, trustless form of money exists. To understand the **blockchain**, we need to understand ***Bitcoin*** as a whole.